

Jesus Heals Hurts and Betrayals

Communion and Foot Washing Prepare the Heart to Receive

I remembered how we began last year's meeting with Communion, and He began to move on me. He said He wanted them to judge themselves as much as possible for what He wants to teach and bring forward. I know His anointing will be here, especially in those teaching services, this blunt teaching. He wants to stretch your spirit. Believe me, He wants to change your life.

He wants us to clear our ground and get everything out.

I was getting ready to preach a two-part series on Communion so we could receive the table tonight. Then He began talking to me about foot washing.

Foot washing is something that has pretty much been lost in the Church. Communion does not save you; it is a remembrance of what He did. Foot washing is the same. The ceremony of either one will not do anything for you unless the significance of it is realized.

We understand, "This is My blood" and "This is My body." But foot washing is rarely even brought up, much less preached on.

When He revealed foot washing to me and its significance, it took forgiveness beyond anything I had experienced. It took the forgiveness I was able to walk in beyond the hurt stages and caused me to receive a peace I did not know a human being could actually receive in the face of being incredibly hurt.

Deep Hurt Comes From People Who Have Been Let Inside

I was in my back room praying because I had just been hurt. I had been hurt so badly I could hardly talk. In fact, it is kind of what is happening to me now. Two things are working in me: great, exceeding joy that makes me want to cry, and remembering what happened that also makes me want to cry.

Somebody had absolutely ripped my heart out and handed it to me on a platter.

It took me a while to realize what the devil was doing. He did not want me to let anybody in on the inside anymore. Casual acquaintances do not hurt you like that. How can a casual acquaintance or casual friend hurt you deeply? If you are really going to be hurt, they have to get in on the inside where they can tear a big hole.

After that was done and He healed me, He was able to teach me quite a bit about staying healed and walking in another degree of peace.

He wanted me to minister this because you are going to have to get it out for God to have maximum access. This week He does not exactly want to be in a deliverance mode. He wants you to be in a receiving mode, so He wants you to get it out.

If I was going to be hurt too many more times, I just was not going to let people in anymore. It is easier to put up barriers and not let anybody cross onto your side of the fence. Just hold them at bay.

How many of you have grown up next to neighbors, lived there twenty years, and you do not even know them? They run in their world, and you run in yours.

He was able to teach me quite a bit about healing and the levels of peace that operate there.

In this circumstance, I was grieving very intensely because I loved this person like my son. I loved him like my sons. He ripped my heart out and handed it to me on a platter. I was grieving so badly it felt like I was grieving myself to death. My heart jumped up into my throat and got stuck there. It hurt so badly I could not talk.

I was reading through this chapter when I had a vision, a supernatural visitation. Not only did God reveal to me what was in the chapter on foot washing, but He healed me at the same time. Then He began to teach me.

If you are able, follow me closely.

Loving Jesus More Provides the Building Material to Finish Your Tower

Jesus said in Luke:

"If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple."

Then He said:

"For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost?"

In the natural, you would calculate the cost right down to the last nail, lest after you begin to build you do not have enough material to finish.

All those verses were one thought. Jesus was saying:

"Any man who comes to Me and does not love his father, mother, wife, children, and his own life less than Me cannot be My disciplined follower. Whoever does not pick up his cross and follow Me cannot be My disciple. For which of you intending to build a tower does not first sit down and count the cost?"

The cost you are counting, whether you will have enough building material to finish your tower, is whether you choose Jesus.

The word for hate means to love them less than Him. If you do not love them less than Him, you will not have enough building material to finish your tower.

The tower He was talking about is finishing your course, saving your family, finishing your ministry, and having the faith and material from God you need to finish your course on this earth.

The cost you are counting is not whether you are called. Who calls himself? Your call was sovereign before the foundations of the world when you were predestined to the adoption of sons. He called you before the foundations of the world. You did not call yourself.

The cost you are counting is whether you should answer the call. Did you call yourself? When was that your choice?

The cost you are counting is the material for finishing the tower. It is whether you will have the building material from God to win your family or lose them. To choose Jesus is to love them less than Him, because that is the only way you will receive from Him what you need to see to their salvation.

Otherwise, you will abort because you will not have what it takes.

I asked Him, "Do I love You more than them?"

I said, "I love You more than them. I do."

Then I asked, "But why?"

He said, "Really, son, you cannot love them more than yourself until you love Me more than them. Where do you think the building material comes from to love them the way you should, if not from Me? If you do not love Me more than them, you will follow them instead of Me. How can you say you are My disciple when you are following someone else?"

When somebody or something in your life occupies the place of Jesus, whether friend, wife, children, money, fame, or life itself, and it is suddenly ripped away, it will leave such a vacuum that He is not there to fill it. That is where grief comes from.

What would I do, hypothetically speaking, if my family did not make it back? I do not have to face that because I am not going to lose them; I have the building material. But what would I do tomorrow? I would go on like I am today, loving Him and finishing my course.

When you love something more than Him and it is ripped away, He will not be there to fill the vacuum.

Jesus as Compensation Removes the Vacuum Betrayal Tries to Leave

When He healed me, after the man I loved like a son and had trained tore my heart out, Jesus came and absolutely healed me.

He gave me understanding: He is my compensation. He is. I do not need anything else. He is all I need in every situation, wherever I go, whatever happens to me. He is the only compensation.

If I spend fifty years on the Amazon and come out with one wrinkled dollar in my pocket, and nobody ever heard of me, He is all the compensation I need.

In Matthew 19 and 20, when Jesus said the first will be last and the last will be first, He went into a parable where a steward went out and hired laborers. One worked eleven hours, and one worked only one hour. The ones who worked eleven hours got exceedingly angry at the one who worked one hour.

The steward said, "Are you angry at me because I have made you equal?"

Then Jesus said, "The first shall be last, and the last shall be first: for many be called, but few chosen."

I used to be confused by that parable because I thought it was some kind of reward system by grace. But when He said the first will be last, the last will be first, and many are called but few are chosen, the parable was signifying the process by which you become chosen.

How do you know the man who worked one hour, if he had had to work eleven, would not have complained about the compensation like the one who worked eleven? You do not know.

What Jesus was saying is this: those who exalt themselves and make themselves first come in last. Those who make themselves last, the servants, come in first. Many are called, but this is the process by which you are chosen.

Some prosperity preachers live for the money, though not all do. Some preach prosperity to put this message to the ends of the earth. But about the ninth hour, if a man loses his Lexus, his house, and everything else, and he gets angry and aborts, why? Because the compensation was not good enough.

The process by which you are chosen is that He becomes your compensation.

When He becomes it all and you choose Him, then you have the building material to finish your tower. There is nothing you can lose that He has not already replaced. There is no vacuum big enough that He cannot fill, because He is all that I need.

Real Friendship Requires Letting People Past Their Worst

The devil did not want me to let anybody inside anymore. Hold them at bay. Do not commit the "sin of familiarity." People have even written books about it.

What is the sin of familiarity? Getting to know each other's faults and not being able to handle it?

You have to hold people at bay? What kind of fellowship is that? There is a search-and-see kind of caution, of course. But if you cannot get past each other's worst, how do you become lifetime friends?

In fact, He told me, "When you can boast of two or three lifetime friends, son, in this life it is the best this life has to offer."

Those kinds of friends are everything. I have friends like that. I do not care what kind of trouble they get into; there is no fortune I would not expend to get them out.

There was a man who was hurting the sheep during a certain time in my ministry. God had me in a grace period because He wanted to recover the man. That is why He sent him to me. I learned more about love during that situation than almost any other.

I had to juggle the balance between how long and to what degree he was hurting the sheep against his recovery. One day, as I was going somewhere, God came on me in my car and said, "The grace period is over."

Up until that time, several believers had come to me and said, "When are you going to do something about him?"

My only answer was, "If you were in trouble and did not know you were in trouble, would that be when you would want me to abandon you?"

I do not think so.

No matter how close you get to me or I get to you, I can promise you no one will ever stand in the position Jesus has now taken. You can rip everything away, everything, and He is all the compensation I need. There will be no horrendous vacuum left because He was already standing there. When it is all gone, He is still standing there.

But if I love anything more than Him and it is ripped away, then I am left with a vacuum, and that is what destroys you.

When Jesus Is Enough, Betrayers Cannot Destroy Your Peace

When He healed me, I was able to begin letting people past the barrier and onto the inside. Sometimes my wife would warn me, "They are going to do you in."

I would say, "I know that, but I know God sent them. I am banking on doing them in before they do me in. I am banking on getting them on the narrow path before they get me on the broad path."

If they try to destroy me, it will not work, because He is already all that I need. He has become my eleventh hour. He is my qualifier. I have passed.

You can take it all. It does not matter to me. He is all that I need. Because He is, I have the building material I need to deal with you. You cannot get ugly enough.

My wife said, "They are going to do you in."

One man did me in. I said, "I know they have that potential."

She said, "They are going to do you in."

I said, "I do not care. I would like them to be my friend. But if they are going to do me in, guess who will come and restore what I got done in for?"

I do not walk in fear like that. I forgive them.

Who did that for you? We are about to go through it.

This person loved me, and I loved them. In fact, they protected me. If I casually mentioned something, they would go get it. You have had friends like that. One day this person stepped between me and another person to protect me because the other person was ordering me around. It did not bother me much. If I wanted to do it, I would do it.

But finally my friend stepped between us and said, "Show some respect."

I thought, Boy, he sure loves me, protecting me like that.

A year or so later, that same person was in my office telling me off. I got the same treatment. I was yelled at for about an hour.

When he left, I was grinning inside. I liked him as a friend. You cannot take my humanity away. But I can tell you this: it left no vacuum.

When he left and God began ministering to me, He said, "Son, I am no respecter of persons. I love all My children the same. Take a lesson. If any person has the power to destroy another person, you are not safe around them. I love all My children. What makes you think they can destroy one of My children and then I will let you go until you get mortified, if you have that same potential?"

Sure enough, my turn came. But he did not destroy me because Jesus had become my compensation. He was all I needed.

It is a wonderful place to walk in. It is a place of peace and love. It is a place of casting your care.

Casting Care Ends the Cycle of One Wounding Person After Another

When people can come into your life, mess you up, and cause you to go into a critical mass where you say, "I am not going to make it; get them out of my life," if that works on you, as soon as you move them out of your life, the devil will move another one in.

I have had a long string of them. Move one out, move another one in. Is there a place on my back where you cannot find a knife?

That is why Jesus said, "You are in the world, but not of it." In Him, you have peace. You are an extension of the kingdom of God, so act like it. The kingdom of God is not meat and drink, but righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.

If a person has the capacity to destroy you and you have the capacity to be destroyed by them, then when they are done with you, they will leave a wretched mess: nerves frazzled, immune system dropped by a fourth because you are under pressure. They leave, you pick yourself up and say, "Thank God he is gone," and then the next one reports for duty.

As long as it works, the devil will not quit sending them.

Do you know when I noticed they let up? When it did not affect me anymore. The devil said, "There is no use sending them anymore."

That is right. When you come into my camp, I am betting I am going to win over you.

I have a master's in casting my care. I have a PhD in casting my care. I am as graceful as a swan. I can run forward with those skinny legs and cast my care on the altar with more grace than I used to have picking it back up.

I used to leave it there for a day or two, then get lonely, go get it, and bring it home. No, I found the missing equation to faith: the ability to cast some horrendous care and problem over onto God and leave it there.

My master's and PhD in peace are called David, Bill, and Steve. They put me through school.

I told God it is a good thing He never sleeps, because He was not going to get any more if He did. About two weeks later, God came into my room, woke me up, and said, "I am going to give these boys back."

I said, "Oh no. You have a problem. I am going back to sleep. They are Your problem."

Someone says, "I am going to sue you."

I would think about that. Why? Because I have a master's in casting my care over onto the Lord. If you sue me, you become my care. I know how to march you right up to the throne, drop you off, and walk away.

If you are saved, you have had your last good night's sleep. If you are not saved, angels are going to deal with you. You have made a mistake.

I found out how to forgive. He is all the compensation I need.

Communion Lets Us Judge Ourselves and Bring Hurt Under the Blood

Tonight, when we judge ourselves in Communion, Scripture says if we would judge ourselves, we would not be judged. We would not be condemned to die of the same damnable things the world dies of.

We take account of our life, bring it under the blood, judge ourselves, then worship Him and thank Him for healing us.

Let me read this a little.

John 13 begins just after Passover. Jesus' life was coming to an end, so He began the last part of His great substitution and identification journey to the cross. Just before He went, He had a foot washing service.

Psalm 41 prophesied:

"Mine own familiar friend, in whom I trusted, which did eat of my bread, hath lifted up his heel against me."

That was fulfilled when Jesus was betrayed by Judas. He called Judas His friend, His trusted friend. Sometimes we think Judas was always lurking in the shadows, never in the inner circle. But Jesus called him His friend. He was.

It is those friends who get in the inner circle and then rip your heart out and hand it back on a platter that hurt the most. But you can only be hurt as badly as the vacuum they leave when they are gone. If Jesus becomes your everything, He is all the compensation you need.

I remember Benny Hinn speaking when his little boy, I think his last one, was born. He was holding the baby in his arms right after birth, and God asked him, "Benny, do you love Me more than him?"

He said, "Yes, God, You know that I do."

God was ensuring the building material for that boy's future.

Benny said, "Yes, Lord, You know that I do."

At a certain point in your mortification, you just have to have God come and help you. There is no more dying outside the power of the Spirit. You make it to a certain place, and you cannot go any further. It has to be Him.

I found that out. I also found out it is not by will worship. My new nature has set me free from Satan's dominion. As long as I make that new nature available to the Holy Spirit and He enforces it, there is nothing, and again I say nothing, that has more power in my life than what Jesus has become to me.

I forgive you just like I know you forgive me. I am not saying I do not have faults. I am saying I have a capacity to continue in God as a yielded vessel until He does with me what I want Him to do.

Jesus Washed Judas' Feet as a Supreme Act of Forgiveness

Jesus had eaten the Passover and then washed the feet of Judas, the man who was about to betray Him.

The reason Judas betrayed Jesus is that, in substitution, Jesus was guilty. He was guilty because He was becoming my sin. He stepped into my shoes to take the penalty I had coming. So He was guilty and had to be turned in, but only as my Substitute. He was not guilty by virtue of doing those things Himself. He was guilty because He stepped into my shoes and was approaching the time when He would take the full penalty I had coming.

So Judas betrayed Him. Jesus was guilty only in respect to substitution and identification.

When Jesus was washing Judas' feet, this is the vision I had. My heart hurt. My throat hurt. I had my feet up on the desk. I was kicked back and praying, hurting. I had read through this chapter hundreds of times.

Suddenly, while reading through Communion, I had the vision. I saw Jesus kneeling and washing this man's feet. His hands were down toward the basin, and I could not see that part very well. What I remember was the look on Jesus' face as He looked intently, with love, up into the man's face.

He was washing the feet of the man He knew was about to betray Him. It was not merely according to the custom of that day, when a traveler came and the servant of the household washed the dirt and mud from his feet and sandals. That was done by the servant of the house.

Jesus said, "My trusted friend has lifted up his heel against Me." That meant every step Judas took as his heel parted from his sandal and he walked away from Jesus was to Jesus' hurt. He had lifted his heel against Him.

Jesus looked intently into his face. Later I found out He was washing the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet in a supreme act of forgiveness.

Jesus said, "If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet, you ought also to wash one another's feet."

In other words, "In a supreme act of forgiveness, I washed the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet. Should you not forgive each other your trespasses?"

Forgiveness Lets the Harm Pass Over You and Rest on Christ

It is those trusted friends whom I let inside who rip my heart out.

But when He healed me through these verses, He said to me:

"In a supreme act of forgiveness, I washed the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet. When you forgive people for their supreme acts of hatred and harmful things, the things they can do to you as no other person can, usually because they are on the inside, then when you wash the filth of betrayal off their feet, all the harm they meant for you will pass over you and come to rest on your Substitute, Jesus, as He took the full penalty for that betrayal."

You may want to hurt me, but you are not going to hurt me, because I know how to forgive you. The harm you meant for me has already been borne by Jesus, and it will come to rest on Him. He suffered under it, and I am the one who will go free because I know how to forgive you.

You are not going to hurt me. It may look like you destroyed me, but watch carefully, because I am going to get up. I will bet my bottom dollar I am going to win you.

Follow me.

John 13 Reveals Foot Washing as Substitutionary Forgiveness

John 13:1-5 says:

"Now before the feast of the passover, when Jesus knew that his hour was come that he should depart out of this world unto the Father,
having loved his own which were in the world, he loved them unto the end.
And supper being ended, the devil having now put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him;
Jesus knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he was come from God, and went to God;
He riseth from supper, and laid aside his garments; and took a towel, and girded himself.
After that he poureth water into a basin, and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded."

Then He came to Simon Peter. Peter reacted the way you and I would. He said, "Lord, dost Thou wash my feet?"

Jesus answered, "What I do thou knowest not now; but thou shalt know hereafter."

In other words, "You do not know what I am doing now, Peter. But later, when I am resurrected and you are born again and can understand spiritual things, you will understand. I am not talking about the custom of the house. I know what you are thinking."

Peter said, "Thou shalt never wash my feet."

The next statement is what made me know this was part of substitution and identification. Jesus said, "If I wash thee not, thou hast no part with Me."

Peter reacted the way many of you would:

"Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head."

Jesus said:

"He that is washed needeth not save to wash his feet, but is clean every whit: and ye are clean, but not all."

This was not about the custom of the day. Jesus said, "You are already clean in the aspect I am ministering, but not all of you," because He was washing the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet.

Verse 11 says:

"For he knew who should betray him; therefore said he, Ye are not all clean."

That is when I saw the vision.

After He had washed their feet and taken His garments, He said:

"Know ye what I have done to you?

Ye call me Master and Lord: and ye say well; for so I am.

If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet.

For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you.

Verily, verily, I say unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord; neither he that is sent greater than he that sent him.

If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them."

If, through a supreme act of forgiveness, Jesus washed the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet, and He was being betrayed in your place, then you should wash the filth of betrayal off the feet of those who betray you. Then all the harm they meant for you, all the destruction they wanted in your life, and all the hurt will pass over you and come to rest on Him who bore that betrayal in your place.

If you can forgive them, you are the one who will go free because Jesus paid the consequences for the betrayal.

I love my family too much for you to get me into strife.

Happiness Follows the Prison-Breaking Practice of Forgiveness

Jesus said, "If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them."

There is a big difference between joy, the fruit of the Spirit, and happiness, which is basically a fruit of circumstances. But peace can make happiness a fruit of joy.

You could be in prison and still have joy. You will be happy when you get out. Happiness is usually tied to circumstances, but Jesus said the man who knows these things and does them is happy.

Why? Because the devil cannot keep him in prison.

The devil sends people who rip your heart out and bind you. You get into hatred and strife, and your life is controlled. You go from one prison to another. There is no happiness.

When I found out your immune system drops by one fourth when you get into hatred, strife, and pressure, I thought, Why would I want that?

At fifty-five, I feel better than I did when I was eighteen. At eighteen I had headaches that put me down. Through my twenties I had back problems that hurt badly. I do not have anything that hurts now.

Happy is the man who knows these things and does them. Does what? Keeps getting delivered from his prisons and walks above them.

The devil cannot bind and control him, because everything people try to do to him, all the harm and all the hurt, was already paid for and carried by Jesus. So continually he is delivered. He is a man who is happy because his circumstances keep coming into line again and again. The devil cannot penalize him, judge him, throw him into prison, and keep him there.

Jesus said:

"I speak not of you all: I know whom I have chosen:
but that the scripture may be fulfilled, He that eateth bread with me hath lifted up his heel against me.
Now I tell you before it come, that, when it is come to pass, ye may believe that I am he.
Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that receiveth whomsoever I send receiveth me;
and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me."

Hallelujah.

Why do you not stand up?